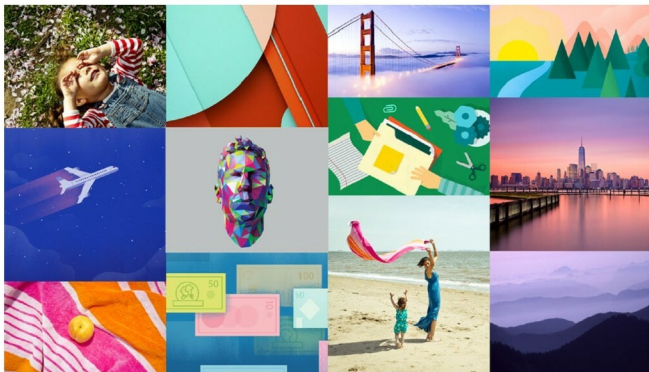


A Guide to Material Design, a Modern Software Design Language

Material Design is a new and continuously evolving design language. The principles and concepts introduced by it appear realistic and pleasing, and it is platform and language independent.



A design language or design vocabulary is an overarching scheme or style that guides the design of a suite of complementary products or architectural settings.

Designers wishing to give their suite of products a unique but consistent look and feel define a design language for it, which can describe choices for design aspects such as materials, colour schemes, shapes, patterns, textures or layouts. They then follow the scheme when designing each object in the suite. In simple words, software design is a set of guidelines, which provides or suggests the design aspects in your software for a consistent look across entire applications. Here's an example: the themes for all activities in Android have the same look and feel. Design languages are only guidelines; they are not rules. These guidelines are designed such that users broadly follow them, but one can surely innovate and bend all the rules of a design language. People tend to consider them hard and fast rules and never do anything outside those guidelines, which is not a good thing in developing engaging user interfaces. These guidelines were also generated by innovation.

The history of design languages

The concept of a design language has existed ever since the

design of user interfaces. The most popular examples of software design languages are:

- Skeuomorphism
- Metro Design
- Flat Design

Skeuomorphism

A skeuomorph is a derivative object that retains ornamental design cues from structures that are necessary in the original. In simple words, skeuomorphism enforces the UIs to be designed to look like the original object of the real world and behave in that way too. Many computer programs have a skeuomorphic graphical user interface that emulates the aesthetics of physical objects.

An example of this trend was the 1998 RealThings package. A more extreme example is found in many music synthesis and audio processing software packages, which closely emulate physical musical instruments and audio equipment. Functional input controls like knobs, buttons, switches and sliders are often careful duplicates of those found on the original physical device being emulated. Some software even include graphical elements of the original